

Worksheet 1

Conversation Lesson – News

Discuss the words in bold.

News on any one day can be about a very wide range of things. Unfortunately, most television channels do not put the **focus** on good news. They are more interested in telling us about **natural disasters** and **scandals**, you know, the depressing stories. And then you can't believe a lot of what they say. The news is like films and general TV, some people think it is a form of entertainment, so the media tends to **sensationalise** stories to get, and keep, people's attention.

It could also be said that there is a lot of **censorship**. Maybe this is a good thing, but not everybody agrees. Some people think the press should not be **restricted**, that a free press is an important part of a free society. Other people think that the media should not be allowed to say what they want.

Finally, a lot of the criticism of the news comes from the fact that many newspapers and TV channels are too interested in **human interest stories**, for example David Beckham's new hairstyle and Britney Spears' marriage problems. It might be interesting to some people, but it's not **current affairs**.

Worksheet 2

You are a television news editor.

All these events have happened today but there isn't enough time to broadcast all the stories on the national TV news at 6pm. You need to decide which 6 stories are newsworthy and then choose the order that they should be presented.

Decide which stories, and give reasons why you chose them:

- A local boy has bought a new bike from the shop (red with 18 gears).
- The President of your country has been involved in a road accident. He is hurt but his life is not in danger.
- An old woman from a small village on the sea has won \$10,000,000 on the national lottery.
- A cat has scratched its owner's sofa.
- A company from your country has won a multi-million pound contract to supply car parts to Ferrari.
- There is a train workers' strike which has resulted in there being no train services all day.
- Weathermen predict that severe weather will hit the capital tomorrow.
- The national economy may go into recession if the government does not solve the unemployment problem.
- A group of schoolchildren have painted pictures of the school dog.
- Your country has won the World Team Darts Championship.
- The national health service advises people not to eat cheese because of a food scare. A bacteria can be found in certain cheese which should be avoided until the problem can be solved.
- A local film maker has been nominated for an Oscar.